

Project Design Decisions and Lessons Learned

Issue 1

The source data contains transactions in multiple currencies (EUR, USD, GBP and CHF).

Why it matters

Transaction amounts in different currencies cannot be aggregated directly because the resulting totals would not be financially meaningful.

Options considered

- Restrict the source data to EUR only.
- Keep multiple currencies but analyze each currency separately.
- Treat all amounts as directly comparable.
- Convert all transaction amounts to a common reporting currency during ETL.

Decision

Transaction amounts will be converted to EUR during the ETL process using fixed reference exchange rates.

Reasoning

This keeps the Business Database unchanged, provides a meaningful ETL transformation, and allows all monetary measures in the Data Warehouse to be aggregated consistently.

Limitation

Historical exchange-rate changes are not considered. In a production banking system, *transaction-date-specific* exchange rates would normally be used.